

New Intel Core processor family

Intel has introduced its all new Core family of processors that are manufac-



Intel Core i7 processor

tured on the company's 32nm process. This technique, along with other advances, helps increase a computer's speed while decreasing energy consumption.

Intel is unveiling several platform products, including more than 25 processors, wireless adaptors and chipsets, including Core i7, i5 and i3 processors, Intel 5 Series chipsets, and Intel Centrino Wi-Fi and WiMAX adaptors that include new Intel My Wi-Fi features. More than 400 laptop and desktop PC platform designs are expected from computer makers based on these products, with another 200 expected for embedded devices. In India, systems are likely to be available from OEMs like HCL, Wipro, Zenith, Acer, MSI, Asus, HP, Lenovo, Sony, Toshiba and Dell as well as from local channel partners.

Mobiles can detect fake notes

A 21-year-old engineering student Neha N. has developed a mechanism to use cellphones as counterfeit note detectors. Recently, she won Rs 100,000

as prize money for her project, at the *Innovation Challenge*, organised by Schneider Electric India.

Said Neha, student of Vidya Vikas Institute of Engineering and Technology in Mysore, "I read a number of surveys by the Intelligence Bureau on the circulation of fake notes...features of currency notes, security features, including water markings and magnetic ink. The most important tips came from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). In October, the bank held an exhibition where officials discussed various features of currency notes and how they are printed."

Using some points during her research, Neha modified her phone to detect fake notes. "The modifications do not disturb any of the normal functions of the cellphone," added Neha. The only requirement is that the cellphone should have the camera feature.

Affordable nano sensors to detect heart attack

A team of Indian scientists and engineers has developed affordable sensors using nano materials to detect a heart attack quickly. The device can also help in early diagnosis by transmitting signals to doctors located remotely.

V. Ramgopal Rao, professor at Indian Institute of Technology, Bombay told the delegates at the 97th Indian Science Congress that a prototype of the portable device would soon be launched to help cardiac patients in the country with quick and cheap diagnosis in time.

E-dog to sniff out explosives

In order to enhance security and check use of improvised explosive devices by terrorists, Indian scientists are developing a high-tech device (an electronic dog) with an electronic nose that will sniff out explosives like RDX.

The electrical engineering depart-

ment of the IIT, Bombay is developing this e-device in collaboration with the High Energy Materials Research Lab of the state-run Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) at Chandigarh and the Madras Atomic Power Station at Kalpakkam near Chennai. The device will be able to sniff presence of IED or RDX in any of the three forms in the way trained canines do.

Portable OS

A 20-year-old engineering student from New Horizon College in Bengaluru has developed a portable operating system (OS) called LinuxP. Developed on the Linux kernel, the OS devised by Niket Chandrashekar supports Windows XP, Vista and 7.

LinuxP has been proved useful in performing tasks like recovering lost files, and locating and installing drivers for printers and other connected devices. It also lets users carry their work on pen drives/cell phones to be ported and extracted through a laptop and work. The software has been developed almost entirely with open source tools and WINE (which allows any Windows-based application to run on other operating systems). There are no licensing or IP concerns in using the software. Niket has plans to put the software online for use by everyone.

Chandrayaan-II scheduled for 2013 launch

India's next moon mission, Chandrayaan-II, will take place in the first quarter of 2013, according to ISRO. Chandrayaan-II is part of a four-year project being carried out by India and Russia. This unmanned mission (like its predecessor) would carry lesser payloads and also investigate the presence of water.

Project director Mylaswamy Anandurai said the designs for the mission's rover and orbiter had been finalised and the fabrication would begin shortly.

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